



**SCHOOL OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS
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**PRM 614X: PROJECT MANAGEMENT SEMINAR
ASSIGNMENT**

Presented by

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Submitted to

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Question

(a) How Sustainable and Regenerative Project Management Challenge Conventional Assumptions

Four largely unexamined presumptions underpin conventional project management: that efficiency entails completing the agreed-upon scope within budget and time; that value is created for and measured by the sponsoring organization; that the project has a limited, contractually defined scope; and that the project is, by definition, a temporary endeavour that ends smoothly at handover. These four presumptions are questioned and finally reconstructed by sustainable project management (SPM) and, more recently, regenerative project management.

Challenging the assumption of efficiency

The "iron triangle" of time, cost, and quality the traditional, task-oriented paradigm of project control assumes a degree of predictability that suits well-structured engineering problems but is incompatible with sustainability challenges, which are intrinsically "wicked" ill-defined, rife with conflicting stakeholder values, and lacking a single right answer (Silviu & Schipper, 2014). It is possible to produce a transit corridor on schedule and within budget while also suffering irreparable ecological damage; traditional efficiency has no bearing on this outcome since it was never intended to account for it (Ebbesen & Hope, 2013).

Therefore, rather than abandoning efficiency, sustainable and regenerative project management redefines it. The pertinent question now is "how little net long-term harm did we cause per unit of value delivered," rather than "how little time and money did we use." In actuality, this frequently means that the project manager wilfully forgoes narrow least-cost efficiency the fastest construction method, the cheapest alignment in favour of methods like phased construction, low-carbon materials, or route realignment around sensitive habitats, which are more expensive or take longer but lessen the project's long-term impact.

Challenging the assumption of value creation

Value in traditional practice is primarily organisational and financial: does the project improve the sponsor's competitive position and provide the return anticipated in the business case (Shenhar,

Dvir, Levy, & Maltz, 2001)? In keeping with Freeman's (1984) stakeholder theory and Elkington's (1997) triple-bottom-line logic of profit, people, and planet, sustainable project management expands the unit of value beyond the sponsoring organization to the larger system of stakeholders the project affects. Regenerative project management goes much beyond. It examines how the project may leave the people and natural systems it touches in a demonstrably better state than it found them, as opposed to how to limit the value it destroys basically a sustainability question (Reed, 2007). When applied to the corridor, this reframes value to include improved or restored environmental services, improved community livelihoods, and real biodiversity net-gain rather than just prevented harm. The single-return-on-investment logic that underpins traditional project assessment is complicated when value generation becomes multi-actor and only partially monetised.

Challenging the assumption of project boundaries

Because projects are bounded undertakings carried out by a temporary team on a defined task before an institutionalised termination returns the outcome to a permanent structure, Lundin and Söderholm's (1995) seminal theory of the temporary organization defines a project through four demarcations: time, task, team, and transition. The negotiated scope, which includes the immediate right-of-way, the construction contract, and the physical alignment, is where traditional project management derives its boundaries. That line is pushed outward by sustainability and regeneration. The corridor's resettlement requirements link it to household livelihood systems that continue for decades after the construction contract concludes; its embedded carbon links it to a global emissions system; and its environmental disturbance links it to a regional biodiversity system. In reality, these kinds of megaprojects are integrated into intricate, multi-actor systems that transcend their official contractual boundaries (Van Marrewijk, Clegg, Pitsis, & Veenswijk, 2008). Therefore, a sustainable and regenerative lens views the "project" as a short-term intervention within a much broader, long-term socio-ecological system and holds the short-term organization partially responsible for consequences that fall well outside of both its contracted scope and its contracted length.

Challenging the assumption of temporariness

By definition, projects are transient; they end when the deliverable is turned over (Lundin & Söderholm, 1995). However, the corridor's social and environmental commitments such as restoring livelihoods for displaced communities and biodiversity offsetting and ecosystem restoration are not one-time deliverables. For years or decades after construction is completed, they are continuing responsibilities that need to be tracked, funded, and modified. Regenerative project management is specifically designed to mitigate this pressure. It reframes the project as the beginning of a longer stewardship relationship that the sponsor maintains with the locations and individuals it has transformed, rather than as a limited event that ends upon handover. Since the only test that matters in the end whether communities and ecosystems are net better off can only be detected long after the temporary organization has split, "success" cannot be confirmed at contractual close-out. This puts pressure on Lundin and Söderholm's transition concept, which is predicated on a seamless transition to a permanent structure; sustainable and regenerative practice, on the other hand, necessitates that some kind of monitoring, funding, or governance capability continue after the temporary organization's institutionalised termination.

These four difficulties make up a system rather than existing separately. Redefining efficiency necessitates redefining value, which pushes the project border outward and exposes duties that extend beyond the temporary organization. Therefore, sustainable and regenerative project management do more than just add new criteria to the current model; they alter the definition of a project, making it a temporary intervention accountable to permanent systems, evaluated by the net condition in which it leaves them, rather than a bounded, temporary delivery mechanism judged by its own internal efficiency.

(b) Ethical and Managerial Trade-Offs

Several traditional development trade-offs are condensed into a single choice in the corridor scenario. The sponsor's job is both a management and an ethical one since each is really two-edged; reasonable individuals operating in good faith would nevertheless dispute about how to settle it.

Economic benefit versus carbon reduction

The corridor's shorter travel times and increased commerce and investment are economic benefits that are recognised quite fast and have a wide range of beneficiaries. Its embodied carbon, which is concentrated in steel, cement, and earthworks, as well as the emissions caused by increased vehicle miles over the course of its operation, are long-term, geographically dispersed costs that are challenging to quantify and whose worst consequences will be felt by future generations. Therefore, the trade-off balances long-term, dispersed, and considerably more difficult-to-price climatic harm versus short-term, concentrated, and clearly quantifiable economic benefit.

Development benefit versus biodiversity

Ecologically vulnerable territory is frequently cut through rather than around by alignment decisions that promote trade access or decrease building costs. Although biodiversity offsets are frequently offered as compensation, the impacted communities in the scenario doubt the validity of these offsets, and for good reason offsets often permit immediate, certain habitat loss in exchange for a promise of future, uncertain ecological restoration elsewhere. The moral dilemma is whether immediate, permanent biodiversity loss may be "traded" for a probabilistic future benefit and who is responsible for the burden of evidence and remedy costs in the event that the offset subsequently performs poorly.

Community rights versus project timelines and cost

One of the most morally problematic aspects of corridor projects is resettlement. Communities impacted by the scenario wonder if compensation is fair; this is a governance and rights problem, not just a budget line. The sponsor effectively passes costs to displaced families when compensation is set too low to safeguard project profitability. Resettlement procedures that are hurried or permit little real participation violate what the infrastructure-justice literature refers to as procedural justice, regardless of the final amount paid. This is different from whether the compensation is ultimately determined to be sufficient, which is a distributive justice issue (Smith-Colin, 2025).

Affordability versus environmental and social compliance costs

In the scenario, communities want substantial compensation and reliable environmental promises, while financiers need ongoing ESG proof. Fulfilling both increases the overall project cost, which

is eventually recouped by taxes, tariffs, or lower investment returns. This begs the question of who should pay the additional costs of carrying out the project responsibly: the state and future taxpayers, the sponsor's shareholders, or the direct users of the corridor through increased fees and tolls. The equity profile of each allocation varies, and imposing the cost on users may make the corridor unaffordable for the same areas it purports to help, especially in cases when those who pay tolls are not the same people who gain from commerce and investment.

Intergenerational equity

While trade, investment, and job advantages mostly benefit the current generation, emissions and biodiversity loss generated today primarily affect future generations, who had no say in the choice. This is the scenario's most pronounced asymmetry: the long-term cost bearers are not the same individuals as the beneficiaries, and thus are unable to take part in the current discussions on alignment, compensation, or offset design. The sustainability concept, which states that a project should not deplete the natural and social "capital" that properly belongs to the future, is based on this issue (Silvius & Schipper, 2014).

Reconciling the trade-offs: managerial approaches

No single formula resolves these conflicts, but three managerial strategies make them explicit and contestable rather than allowing them to be resolved silently in the sponsor's favour.

- Stakeholder salience mapping (Mitchell, Agle, & Wood, 1997) determines which voices are structurally underweighted in project decision-making based on factors including power, legitimacy, and urgency. Future generations and impacted communities usually have low formal authority but legitimacy and urgency, thus governance design must purposefully make up for this disparity.
- Multi-criteria, ESG-linked appraisal substitutes a scorecard covering economic, social, environmental, and governance dimensions for a single financial metric, like net present value, so that trade-offs are apparent rather than reduced to a single figure before anyone outside the finance team sees them.
- As the scenario outlines, independent verification and ongoing ESG reporting to financiers establish an external accountability mechanism that restricts the sponsor's capacity to make

environmental commitments it breaks, directly resolving the credibility issue brought up by impacted communities.

The underlying trade-offs are not eliminated by any of these tools. They achieve this by transforming a set of choices that the sponsor could have made in private during the design phase into choices that are public, open, and susceptible to renegotiation during the course of the project. The transport corridor cannot be reduced to a single viability question; instead, the project manager must maintain two concurrently true but contradictory claims: that the project is a public good and that it is also a source of actual, unevenly distributed harm. Additionally, the project manager must create governance structures that are strong enough to manage that tension throughout the corridor's existence, not just at the point of approval.

Question Two

(a) Limitations of Cost, Time, Scope and Quality as Measures of Success

Project success was almost exclusively operationalised for the first forty years or so of project management as a formal profession using what Pinto and Slevin (1988) called the "triangle of virtue": cost, time, and quality, which was subsequently expanded to include scope. The implementation contractor in the scenario may point to it and call the project a success since it is objective, observable during execution, and immediately enforceable through contracts, all of which contribute to its enduring appeal. However, when applied to intricate, public-facing initiatives like a national digital-health platform, this paradigm has at least five structural drawbacks.

It conflates project management success with project success

De Wit (1988) and Munns and Bjeirmi (1996) make a fundamental distinction between project management success, which is determined by how successfully the project was carried out in comparison to the plan, and project success, which is determined by whether the final product truly fulfils its intended purpose when it is put into use. The first requirement is nearly entirely met by the digital health platform, which is developed to specification, on budget, and only slightly late. However, given its unequal acceptance and uncertain therapeutic impact, the scenario may be

failing the second requirement, according to the evidence. Cost, time, scope, and quality are all part of the first category; thus, they are fundamentally unable to record the second, allowing "success" to be announced before the result that matters to patients and clinicians has ever been assessed.

It is silent on benefits realisation and strategic value

he platform exists and operates according to specifications; outputs are described by cost, time, and scope. They don't discuss results, such as whether patients truly have meaningful access to treatment or whether professionals genuinely alter their decision-making processes. According to Zwikael and Smyrk (2012) and Serra and Kunc (2015), benefits realisation management views the conversion of outputs into intended organisational or societal benefits as a separate phase of the value chain that usually goes well beyond the formal project closure point that the iron triangle measures. The scenario clearly states that the expected advantage better clinical decision-making has not yet been shown, indicating that the iron triangle's verdict of success is being given before the intended benefit has really materialised.

It cannot accommodate stakeholder plurality

Success is evaluated differently and at different times by various stakeholders (Ika, 2009; Turner & Zolin, 2012). County governments concerned with equitable geographic access, a funding agency seeking quantifiable health outcomes, patient groups evaluating their lived experience of access and usability, and a contractor evaluating contractual compliance cannot all be represented by a single scalar judgment on budget, on time, in specification, therefore successful. The scenario's starkly disparate evaluations across different parties are not a communication breakdown that needs to be fixed; rather, they are the inevitable result of using a single-dimension yardstick to evaluate what is actually a multi-stakeholder project.

It privileges an early, static snapshot

The iron triangle favours an early picture of a system that is still developing since cost, time, and scope are usually evaluated at or close to contractual close-out. Clinical-outcome evidence, adoption curves, and operating-cost trends all develop over a longer time span than the actual delivery period. Evaluating success at handover runs the danger of certifying success too soon and

fundamentally promotes the contractor's short project-management horizon over the funding agency's and patients' longer outcome horizon (Ika & Pinto, 2022).

It omits equity and sustainability altogether

The scenario makes clear that operational costs are already greater than anticipated and that patients in rural places have limited access. The distributive equality of access and the platform's continued operational sustainability are not represented by the traditional definitions of cost, time, scope, or quality, but both will ultimately determine whether the system survives and fulfils its intended function.

The implementation contractor is correct about the iron triangle: the project was, in a limited sense, properly managed. The issue is that, despite the scenario's own evidence uneven adoption, unequal access, increased running costs, and unproven therapeutic benefit "well managed" and "successful" have been used interchangeably.

(b) A Multidimensional Success Framework

The eight dimensions listed below differentiate project management efficiency, output quality, stakeholder value, strategic alignment, benefits realisation, sustainability, resilience, and distributive equity. These dimensions build upon Shenhar, Levy, and Dvir's (1997) and Shenhar et al.'s (2001) multidimensional, time-contingent model of project success as well as on later benefits-realization, resilience, and infrastructure-justice scholarship. The example demonstrates that each dimension might point in a different direction at the same time, answer a different question, and become observable on a separate time horizon.

Dimension	Guiding Question	Time Horizon	Assessment Digital-Health Platform
1. PM Efficiency	Was the project delivered as planned, on cost, on time, to scope?	<i>At / near close-out</i>	High within approved budget, only two months behind schedule, met original technical specification (Atkinson, 1999).
2. Output Quality	Does the deliverable meet its technical and functional specification?	<i>At handover</i>	High system meets the original technical specification (Pinto & Slevin, 1988).

3. Stakeholder Value	Do the groups who use or are affected by the system judge it as worthwhile?	<i>Short–medium term</i>	Contested health workers, patients, counties, funder and contractor offer sharply differing assessments (Mitchell, Agle, & Wood, 1997).
4. Strategic Alignment	Does the project advance the health system's broader strategic goals?	<i>Medium term</i>	Uncertain uneven adoption undermines the rationale for a national platform (Shenhar et al., 2001).
5. Benefits Realisation	Are the intended benefits actually being produced and sustained?	<i>Medium–long term</i>	Not yet achieved expected improvements in clinical decision-making remain undemonstrated (Zwikaël & Smyrk, 2012).
6. Sustainability	Can the system keep operating within available resources long-term?	<i>Long term</i>	At risk operating costs already exceed forecast (Silvius & Schipper, 2014).
7. Resilience	Can the system anticipate, absorb and adapt to disruption without losing core function?	<i>Ongoing</i>	Untested limited access in remote areas suggests weak adaptive capacity for connectivity gaps (Rahi, 2019).
8. Distributive Equity	Are benefits and burdens shared fairly across geography and population groups?	<i>Ongoing</i>	Poor remote-area patients experience materially worse access than urban peers (Smith-Colin, 2025).

The eight aspects of the framework are layered; it is not a straightforward checklist to be completed. As gatekeeper dimensions, project management effectiveness and output quality are essential but insufficient prerequisites for stakeholder value and strategy alignment, both of which are prerequisites for the realisation of benefits. When advantages are ultimately realised, sustainability, resilience, and distributive equality determine whether they can be sustained and equitably distributed. As a result, a project might nearly flawlessly meet the first two criteria while failing miserably at the level that finally determines whether it was worthwhile. This is precisely the case with the digital-health platform.

In this instance, the contractor may only rightfully claim dimensions 1 and 2, which are part of the iron triangle's area. Users, county governments, the funding agency, and patient groups all reach different conclusions from the contractor because dimensions 3 through 8 require data, time, and ongoing stakeholder engagement that the project has not yet produced. This is because each is

implicitly weighting a different subset of these eight dimensions. The practical implication for project governance is to incorporate resilience testing, equity-disaggregated adoption monitoring, and benefits-realization tracking into the post-implementation phase, with the funding agency and county governments acting as co-owners of the definition of success rather than as its final, disgruntled judges.

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